



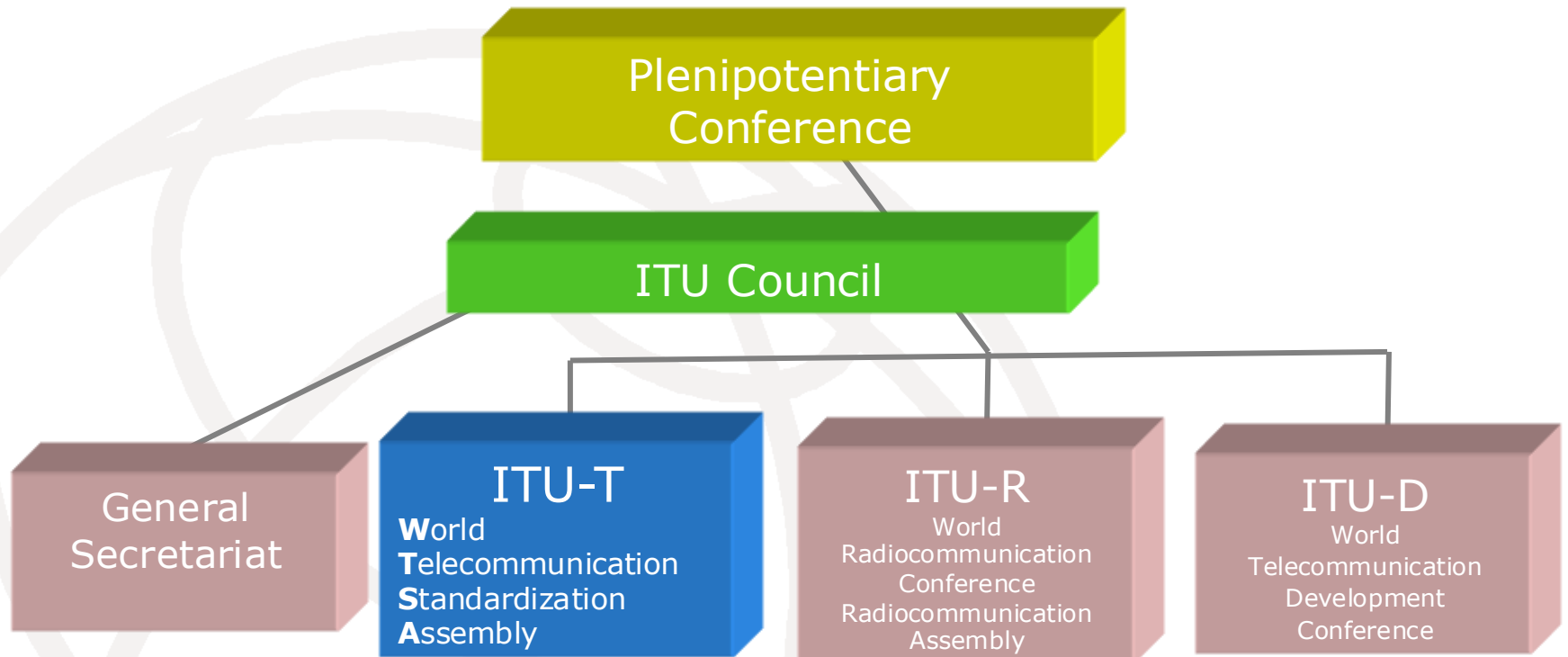
ITU Telecommunication Standardization: Accessibility to ICTs for persons with disabilities

**Symposium of Telecommunications Regulators
XIII International Convention Informática
Havana, 11 February 2009**

Malcolm Johnson
Director, TSB

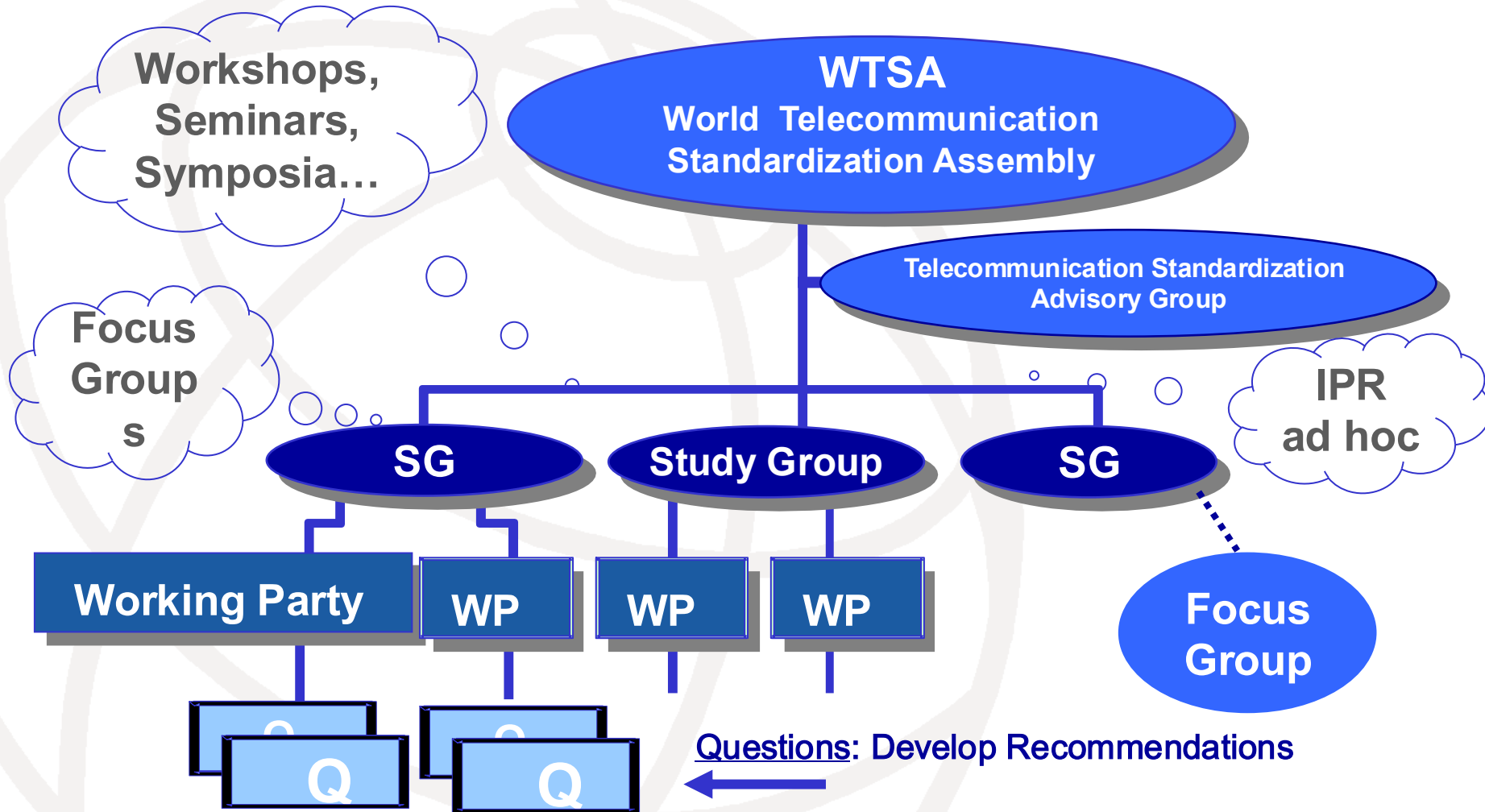
Committed to connecting the world

ITU Structure



Committed to connecting the world

ITU-T Structure



Committed to connecting the world

Free Recommendations

- Since beginning of 2007, ITU-T Recommendations are available without charge for a trial period.
- With only a small number of exceptions all in-force ITU-T Recommendations are available in PDF form via a simple mouse click:

itu.int/ITU-T/publications/recs.html

ITU-T Study Groups

- SG 2 Service definition, numbering and routing, telecommunications for disaster relief/early warning, telecommunication management
(Vice-Chairman: Mr Marcos Pérez García (Cuba))
- SG 3 Tariff and accounting principles including related telecommunication economic and policy issues
- SG 5 EMC and electromagnetic effects
- SG 9 Integrated broadband cable and TV networks
- SG 11 Signaling and protocols, intelligent networks and test specifications
- SG 12 Quality of service and quality of experience
- SG 13 Future networks, NGN, mobility management and fixed-mobile convergence
- SG 15 Access network transport, optical technology and optical transport networks
- SG 16 Multimedia, ubiquitous applications, accessibility for persons with disabilities
- SG 17 Security, identity management (IdM)

WTSA-08 Statistics

- Five regional preparatory meetings (Brazil, Ghana, Uzbekistan, Syria, Viet Nam) in association with Regional Development Forums on Bridging the Standards Gap in collaboration with BR, BDT and Regional Offices
- Resulted in regional common proposals from five regions
- WTSA adopted 21 new Resolutions, revised 27 existing Resolutions, adopted two new Recommendations and revised 7 existing Recommendations
- Total of 350 contributions
- 99 participating countries
- Over 1000 attendees
- 13 Ministers/Vice-Ministers
- VIPs spanning the world and the ICT industry sector

Bridging the Standards Gap

- **Resolution 44** recognises the efforts being made to meet PP-06 Resolution 123
 - Encourages developed countries to establish cooperation programmes with developing countries
 - Suggests a separate expenditure line in ITU budget for bridging standardization gap
 - Encourages voluntary contributions (so far only Korea, Nokia-Siemens, Cisco and Microsoft have contributed to the fund)
 - More guidelines to explain ITU-T Recommendations and their application with emphasis on Recommendations having regulatory and policy implications
 - Encourages remote participation (100 ITU-T meetings had remote participation in 2008);
- Develop mechanism to measure results
- Actions to be performed:
 - Compile and maintaining a database containing information on new standardised technologies
 - Organizing training courses on the application of specific Recommendations and on methods of examining compliance of manufactured products with these Recommendations

New Resolution on Accessibility

- **Resolution 70** encourages more work in the field of telecommunication/ICT accessibility for persons with disabilities

considering

- That the World Health Organization estimates that ten per cent of the world's population (more than 650 million people) are persons with disabilities, and that this percentage may increase

invites the Director of the Telecommunication Standardization Bureau

- To identify and document examples of best practice for accessibility
- To review the accessibility of ITU-T services and facilities
- To work collaboratively on accessibility-related activities with ITU-D, in particular developing programmes that enable developing countries to introduce services that allow persons with disabilities to utilize telecommunication services effectively
- To work collaboratively and cooperatively with other standardization organizations and entities... in the interest of ensuring that ongoing work ... is taken into account, in order to avoid duplication
- To work collaboratively and cooperatively with disability organizations

ITU-T work on accessibility

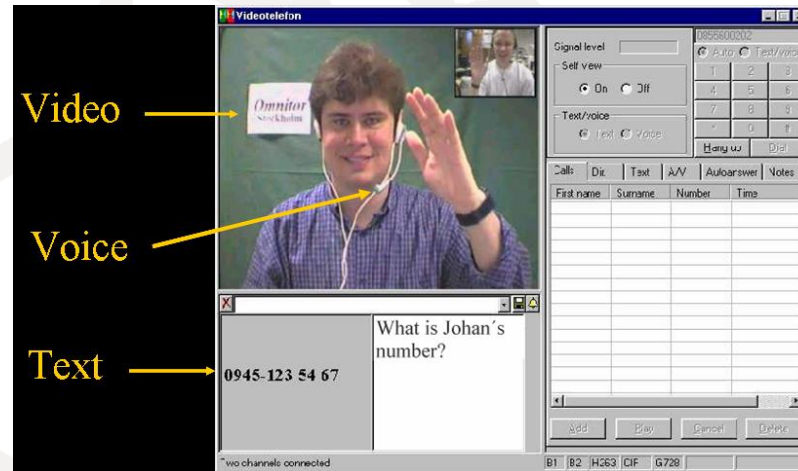
- Joint coordination activity on accessibility and human factors (JCA-AHF) coordinates standardization activities on accessibility and human factors issues
 - Open to experts working in the field to improve access to the information society by people with varied capability of handling information and the controls for its presentation
- Dynamic Coalition on Accessibility and Disabilities, under the Internet Governance Forum
- Global Standards Symposium recognized that accessibility to telecom/ICT services is a major enabler to economic and social development.....in part because a significant percentage of persons with disabilities are poor and live in developing countries
- ITU-T SG16 lead SG on accessibility (Question 26)
- Workshop planned in Geneva, October 2009

Accessibility landmarks

- First international standards body to address accessibility issues - in 1991
- 1994 the international text telephone standard, Recommendation ITU-T V.18, was published
 - A major landmark tying together text telephone protocols allowing different - previously incompatible - textphones in different countries to communicate
- Since then, ITU-T's accessibility experts have helped to incorporate accessibility needs into standards for:
 - Multimedia
 - Network interoperability
 - Multimedia service descriptions
 - Multimedia conferencing
 - Next generation networks (NGN)

Total Conversation

- Rec. ITU-T F.703



- An audiovisual conversation service providing bidirectional symmetric real-time transfer of motion video, text and voice

ITU recognizes dedication to accessibility cause

- All new ITU-T Recommendations will be checked against accessibility criteria
- 2008: World Telecom & Information Society Day
 - Helped raise awareness of the possibilities that ICTs can bring to all.
 - Laureat: Andrea Saks

Andrea Saks



ITU-D Special Initiatives

Promoting ICT Accessibility for Persons with Disabilities

- An Initiative out of WTDC-06 creating awareness and skills to mainstream disability issues.
- Promoting equal ICT opportunities for PwDs.
- Supporting member states meet obligations under Article 9 of the UN Convention for Rights of PwDs.



In addition, ITU-D SG1-Q20, developed Guidelines for ICT accessibility for PwDs & collection of country level statistics on PwDs is in progress



ITU-D and G3ict are developing an on-line toolkit for training policy makers, regulators, other stakeholders:

- Develop and mainstream ICT policies for PwDs
- Share experiences and best practice

ITU-D also supports ICT projects for PwDs and provides workshops on ICTs issues for PwDs.

Future ITU-D activities

- Capacity building on policies and awareness on ICT accessibility issues via on-line toolkit
 - Training policy makers and stakeholders
 - Platform for best practice and electronic repository of policies on ICT accessibility
- Projects on accessible ICTs in partnership with member states & other stakeholders

Some new Resolutions and a new ITU-T Recommendation

- **Resolution 58** to encourage the creation of national Computer Incident Response Teams (CIRTs) particularly for developing countries
- **Resolution 71** to encourage cooperation between ITU-T and academia, universities and their associated research establishments, and invite Council to consider reduced fee
- **Resolution 73** on ICTs and Climate Change encourages the membership to work towards reductions in greenhouse gas in line with the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
- **Resolution 74** instructs Director TSB to propose to Council reduced ITU-T fee for Sector Members from developing countries based on ITU-D model, and that it include its consideration of this matter in preparation of PP-10
- **Recommendation ITU-T D.156** asks that developing countries examine appropriateness of a network externality premium on incoming international traffic from the operators of developed networks to the operators of developing-country networks to fund extending networks in developing countries

Internet related

- **Recommendation ITU-T D.50** asks that international Internet connection arrangements take into account the possible need for compensation for the value of elements such as traffic flow, number of routes, geographical coverage and cost of international transmission, and the possible application of network externalities.
- **Resolution 69** invites Members to refrain from taking any unilateral and/or discriminatory actions that could impede another Member State to access public Internet sites, within the spirit of Article 1 of the ITU Constitution and WSIS principles and to report any such incident to TSB.

IP address allocation and encouraging the deployment of IPv6

- **Resolution 64** instructs ITU-T Study Groups 2 and 3 to study the allocation and economic aspects of IP addresses taking account of the ITU workshop on IPv6 in September 2008

instructs the Director TSB in close collaboration with the Director BDT:

- to initiate a project to assist developing countries responding to their regional needs
- to establish a website that provides information about global activities related to IPv6
- to promote awareness of the importance of IPv6 deployment

further instructs the Director of TSB:

- to study the question of IPv6 address allocation and registration for interested members and, especially, developing countries
- to report to the 2009 session of the ITU Council

Conformance and interoperability testing

- **Resolution 76** requires ITU-T to develop conformance and interoperability testing Recommendations as quickly as possible
- ITU-T in collaboration with the other sectors will:
 - Assist developing countries in identifying training opportunities
 - Assist developing countries in establishing regional or subregional conformity and interoperability test centres
- Instructs the Director TSB in cooperation with BDT and BR to identify and prioritize the problems faced by developing countries
- Based on results produce a report for Council 2009 on:
 - i) the overall effect on ITU and manufacturers
 - ii) legal, national and international regulatory implications
 - iii) cost of setting up of facility
 - iv) location of testing facility
 - v) measures to be taken to build the necessary human-resource capacities
- To carry out the necessary studies with a view to introducing the use of an ITU Mark including financial and legal implications for ITU-T and for ICT industries, and other concerns
- Invites Council to report to PP-10

Actions

- Increased number of study group meetings in the regions planned
- New regional group meetings planned
- Workshops in regions on implementation of WTSA-08 actions and application of ITU-T Recommendations in regions
- Fellowships now available for all ITU-T study group meetings
- New ITU-T Flagship Group for Latin America
- Study Group 3 Regional Group for Latin America, Lima, Peru 22 to 26 June 2009
- ICT and Climate Change Symposium, Quito, Equator 9 to 11 July 2009 preceded on 8 July by a briefing on the ITU implementation of the WTSA-08 decisions
- NGN-GSI and ITU-T SGs 11 and 13 Mar del Plata, Argentina 2 to 12 September preceded by the "Kaleidoscope" 31 August and 1 September 2009

Conclusions

- ITU world's pre-eminent global ICT standards body
- Bridging the standardization gap recognised as essential to ITU's mission to Connect the World
- New team of chairmen and vice-chairmen from 33 countries
- First SG15 meeting since WTSA-08 was completely paperless, had largest ever participation (367 delegates) largest ever number of contributions (336) consented 28 Recommendations including new high profile global standard on home networking:
 - PC World (US) 13.12.08: "The powerful world standards organization ...[ITU].. has reached agreement on G.hn a set of specifications that would encompass phone lines, power lines, and coaxial cable to provide HDTV room to room..."
- Full list of WTSA Resolutions is at:
<http://www.itu.int/publ/T-RES/e>